League Championship Series

THE RIFT REVIEW
FEB 2021

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STANDINGS

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C9 PERKZ: EU TO NA

EU's star midlaner made his way from powerhouse G2 to NA's heavyhitter C9. This month, we hit him with your hardest questions: what are the differences in top teams in EU and NA? Is the C9-TL rivalry still burning stong? How OP is Yone? Who's the biggest competition in midlane? What's your go-to McDonald's order? And most importantly: is NA > EU?

ALSO IN THIS ISSUE

- February's Matches
- Patch Meta Review
- LCS Power Rankings
- TSM vs. TL: Fight for First

THIS MONTH'S SCHEDULE

MATCH OF THE WEEK

WEEK 1

SAT	SUN
VS.	VS.
VS.	VS.
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VS.	VS.

WEEK 2

SAT	SUN
VS.	VS.
VS.	VS.
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WEEK 3

SAT	SUN
VS.	VS.
VS.	VS.
VS.	VS.
VS.	VS.
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WEEK 4

SAT	SUN
VS.	VS.
VS.	VS.
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C9 PERKZ: EU TO NA

This season, the LCS welcomes Luka "Perkz" Perković to Cloud9. Perkz is known as the a star midlaner from EU, previously playing for 5 years on top EU team G2 Esports. Now he's come to NA to make a name for himself.

But now that he's been in NA for a year and played on our serves, what does Perks think about the state of the League? What's his favorite part about NA? And what are the many ways that NA is clearly superior to EU? We asked him all these questions and more in our exclusive interview!

Q: Hey, Perkz! Thanks for taking time for this interview. How are you?

Thank you, yes, I'm good. Very happy to be here.

Q: Great! So, just getting right into it: what was your biggest surprise coming from EU to NA?

Oh, that's a hard question. I don't know, there were a lot of different things that were kind of a culture shock. Do you mean, like, in the game or in general?

Q: Point taken. How about we start with the game?

Sure. Hm, I think the most different thing is that solo queue is much more aggressive at the top of the ladder than it is in EU. In NA, there's a lot more invades and level 1 skirmishes in the jungle. Stuff that is kind of coinflip, to be honest, but it's pretty fun when it happens. It makes the games in NA more snowbally more often.

Q: Great! And then how about the biggest difference outside of the game?

The food portions! They're much bigger here than in EU. I think the first month I came here, I would take half of my lunch with me whenever I went out back home and heat it up for dinner. I heard that the sizes were different, but I didn't really realize by how much until I got here. I mean, I've visited the United States a few times for international competitions, you know, so I kind of had an idea of the portions already, but really eating out everyday was an experience for a while.

Q: Oh, you've been going out to eat? What's your favorite food?

Oh, that's hard too! Not sure, I've had a lot of good food since I got here. I think the best thing about L.A. is that there's so many different options. Honestly, it gets kind of overwhelming at times. I guess what I've been getting the most lately is Korean barbeque. I think I go out at least once a week to eat it with my team, it's crazy.

Q: Great. And, you know, everyone on Twitter wants to know, what's your go-go McDonald's order?

Oh, are they wondering that? [laughs] Uh, honestly I haven't gotten a lot of McDonald's since I moved here, but usually I get 10 McNuggets and a McDouble. And a large Cola and medium fries.

Q: Well, it sounds like you're having a good time, which is great. Now, could you tell us the differences between being on a top team in NA and a top team in EU?

I'm not sure, honestly. I guess you would expect that there'd be a couple of differences, but honestly there's not a lot. The schedule and everything is basically the same. I haven't really had to make any adjustments on that front.

Oh, I guess since I've joined C9, I've been in vod review meetings more, but I think that's mostly because I'm new to the team and we're still practicing with each other. I don't think it's really a reflection of what we'd do if we were 5 teammates used to each other, like when I was on G2.

Q: Awesome. Getting into some game-specific questions, you've pulled out Yone mid more than any other player this season. Do you think the pick is hidden OP?

Yeah, I think it's pretty good, and obviously my team does too or I wouldn't just pick it every game, you know, without them being okay with it.

Q: What makes Yone so strong?

He just has a lot in his kit. I think his E and his ult are what make him so strong. His E lets him go in without committing too hard, so it lets him farm safely for a melee champion, and his ult is basically impossible to dodge unless you flash, so it's a really good engage or follow up tool. And he has good scaling with crit and comes online really early with two items. Basically, once he hits a point, he one shots your backline and you can't really punish him.

Q: But it's basically just you and Jensen who're picking Yone. Why is that?

Uh, just built different I guess? [laughs]

I think it's because Yone takes a lot of time to get used to. Early game he can be punished early if you don't play it right. So, if you don't have correct jungle support or if you just misplay in lane, you'll probably be useless until the game ends. It's a risky playstyle that most teams probably don't want to play if they could play something safer like Viktor or Syndra or any of those others. If that's the case, then it's probably not worth taking the time to learn to how to play Yone for most players. Honestly, I don't think many EU players are playing Yone either.

Q: So, what's your favorite champion to play then? Yone?

Yeah, Yone is definitely pretty fun. I think he is probably my favorite right now. I like playing Yasuo as well.

Q: And who's your least favorite champion to play against?

In general? I guess control mages like Viktor and Orianna. They're not really hard matchups all the time, depending on who I'm playing, but usually they're pretty boring matchups. There's no fighting in that lane and you only farm. I think that's pretty boring, personally, so I don't like playing those matchups.

Q: And switching gears a little, you're playing against TL this month. What has stepping into that rivalry been like?

That's an interesting question. I mean, I have experience with team rivalries since I was playing on G2 and we were usually in contest with Fnatic, but I was pretty much living in that competition for 5 years, so it felt really personal to me. When I think about it like that, I think it would be wrong to say that I feel very personally about the C9-TL rivalry, since I just arrived in NA.

But that said, I do think it's pretty exciting to be part of the rivalry. I've watched a couple of the old games between the two teams, and it was pretty exciting to watch. And I think seeing all the promotional stuff about it and reading about the fans excited about the games have really hyped me up. I definitely don't want to disappoint anyone's expectations. I think they're going to be some fun games.

Q: That's great to hear. Then, are there any teams or players you're looking forward to playing against in NA?

Jensen for sure. Definitely think he is the best midlaner in NA right now, so naturally I want to play against him.

I would've definitely liked to play against Bjergsen for sure. Obviously that's not possible anymore, which I'm disappointed by, because I thought he was the best midlaner in NA other than Jensen. But I think POE is a good player also. He never does what you expect, and I respect that.

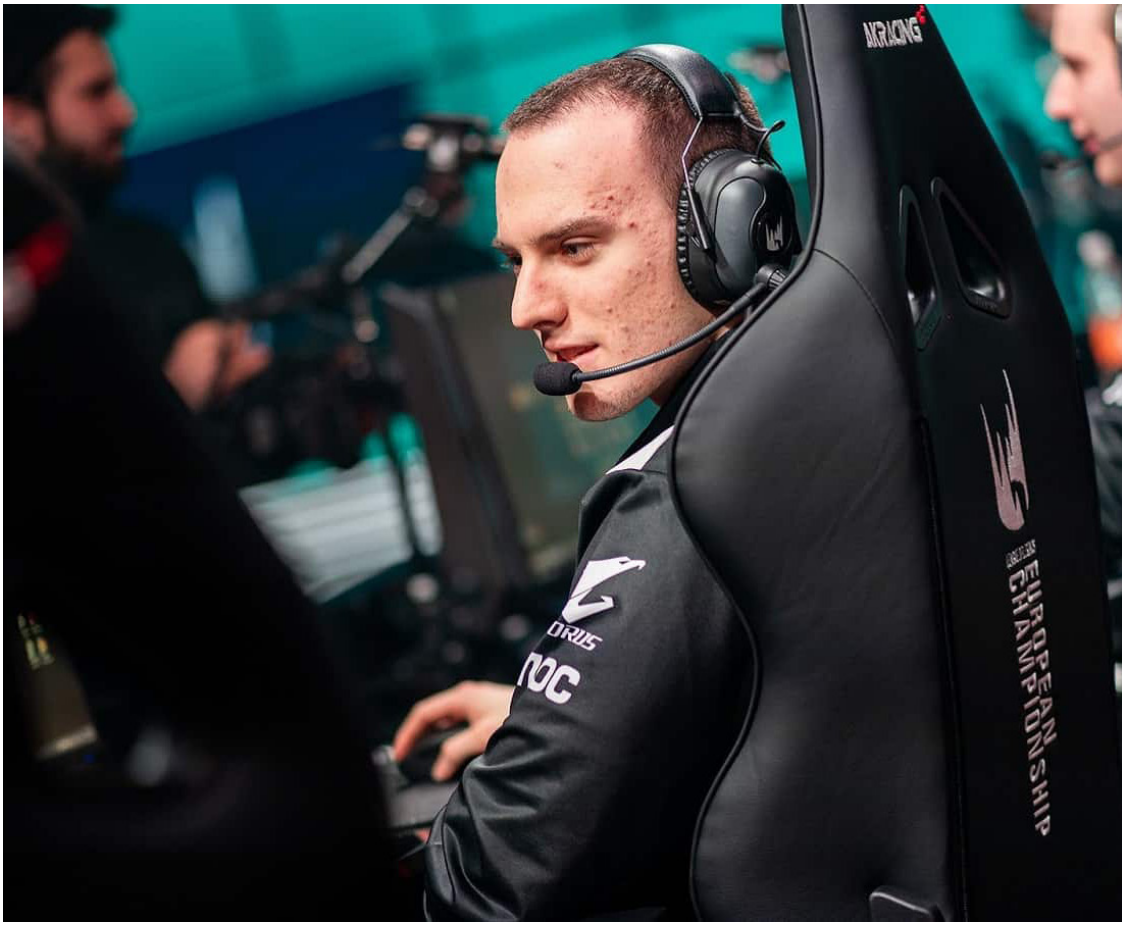
Q: Hopefully you get the matches you're looking for! Alright, so on to the all-important question. Is EU truly greater than NA?

[Laughs] Uh, am I allowed to answer that question? I think I'll be kicked off my team if I answer wrong, you know.

No, I'm kidding. I think there's a lot of differences, so it's hard to make a general comparison. But honestly, during my time in NA, I think the top teams, at least, are on par with EU teams. It's not like I've had it easy in these games. I had to practice and ask my teammates for help. But I think EU tends to have more infrastructure for pro play compared to NA.

But, uh, NA > EU, obviously. I'm officially NA now, right?

Q: That's all our questions. Perkz, thank you so much for your time, and good luck this month and for the rest of your season!

Yeah, of course. I was really happy to be here and I appreciate the interview. I hope I can deliver some fun matches for the NA fans.

Go C9!